

# The CMO's Diagnostic Toolkit

Five frameworks to find your real growth bottleneck — before you spend another rupee on marketing that treats the wrong disease.



## Framework 1: Decompose the number

Revenue is traffic times conversion times value. A 20% decline with stable traffic is a conversion problem. Stable conversion with falling traffic is a distribution problem. Most teams treat symptoms; decomposition tells you which building to enter.

Exercise: pull twelve months of data and force every metric into one of the three multipliers. The bottleneck announces itself.



## Framework 2: Segment the fall

Aggregate curves hide the truth. Is the decline uniform, or concentrated in one region, channel or cohort? Most 'company-wide' problems are one broken engine dragging the average.



## Framework 3: Listen to the market, not the meeting

Win-loss interviews, review mining and sales-call recordings outperform boardroom hypotheses.  
In a recent engagement, the board believed price was the issue; the calls said availability.  
The shelf was empty, not the wallet.



## Framework 4: Stress-test the basics

Pricing integrity, distribution coverage, share of search. Boring metrics — but declines are boring problems wearing dramatic costumes. Check the fundamentals before funding the exotic.



## Framework 5: One hypothesis, one intervention

Recovery plans with twelve initiatives credit nothing and teach less. Run one hypothesis with one measured intervention per window. Diagnose narrowly, act decisively, measure honestly.

This toolkit mirrors the diagnostic process MarKendrick runs in every Diagnostic Audit — available as a one-time engagement delivered in 1-2 weeks.

# Want this working for your brand?

Book a free 20-minute consultation at [markendrick.com](https://markendrick.com) or write to [hello@markendrick.com](mailto:hello@markendrick.com). A senior consultant — never a bot — replies within one business day.

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